

Method Pilot: Test the Test

I can carry out or direct a small method pilot, identify a procedural problem and revise the plan ready for W14.

PILOT

test one practice procedure

REPAIR

fix the method, not the result

READY

approve a route for W14

[Open the original interactive lesson](#)

What success looks like

- Follow the pilot checklist using one practice route, not final A/B comparison samples.
- Record a method observation or fault without turning the pilot value into a rock conclusion.
- Make one precise revision and issue an honest ready, repair or digital-route decision for W14.

Retrieve and reconnect

- Last lesson: what is the difference between pilot and final investigation?
- Last lesson: name one control the pilot should check.
- Last week: why must final A/B result cells stay blank today?
- Lead-in: what makes a method revision precise enough for another person to follow?

Pilot P1 uses one practice sample. One millilitre leaks around the collar edge. What should happen next?

Think first. Point, say, sign or write your choice. Give one reason.

- A. Use the tray water to decide the practice rock is highly permeable.
- B. Record the edge leak as a method fault, revise the seal check and pilot the repaired method again or use the fixed route.
- C. Hide the leak and copy the expected value so the method looks ready.

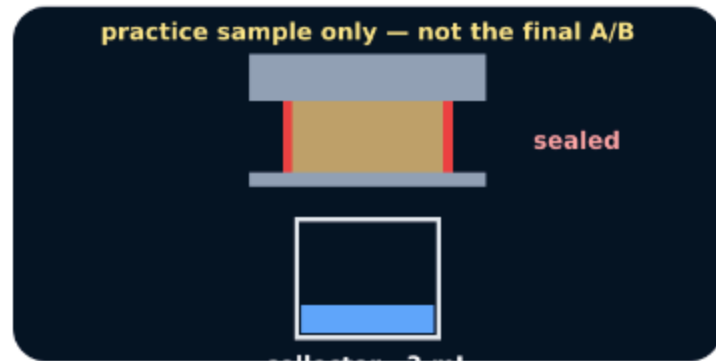
Look closely · what is the evidence?

Pilot purpose: check whether the procedure produces a valid record.

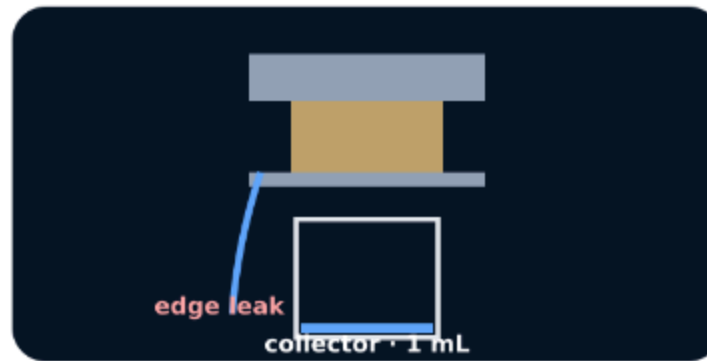
Fault observed: water bypassed the practice sample at the edge.

Revision target: make the seal-check step clear before any W14 final trial.

Look closely · what is the evidence?



A practice run on the bench



An edge leak during the pilot



Three readiness decisions

Words we will use

- pilot — small practice run
- fault — a problem in the method
- revise — change the plan clearly

Watch the model

- Keep final Samples A and B out of the pilot. Use one clearly labelled practice sample or the fixed pilot log so today cannot become the full comparison.
- Follow the checklist: stable tray, seal check, 5 mL, timer ready, 120 seconds, collector in mL, stop rule and clear recording box.
- Record procedure evidence such as seal held, timer clear or unit missing. The pilot value is not used to decide which final rock is more permeable.

Which pilot response improves the future investigation without creating a false conclusion?

- A. A leak occurs, so record 'practice rock is permeable' and start W14.
 - B. A leak occurs, so add 'choose and inspect the seal before adding 5 mL'; rerun the practice route and keep final A/B results blank.
 - C. A leak occurs, so change the sample, water volume and time together until a neat value appears.
- Commit to an answer. Show the evidence you used. Listen, then revise if needed.

Build the explanation

- Compare method version 1 with version 2. Highlight the exact changed instruction, such as check the seal all the way around before adding water.
- Run a readiness check: can another person identify the practice sample, volume, time, unit, collector, stop rule and blank final table without asking what you meant?
- Issue one decision: READY FOR W14, REPAIR THEN REVIEW or USE FIXED DIGITAL/DATA ROUTE. None of these decisions includes a final permeability conclusion.

Find and repair the misconception

Pilot glitch: the first practice value proves which final rock will be most permeable.

A. Keep it: one practice reading answers the final A/B question.

B. Repair it: the pilot tests instructions and equipment; final matched A/B repeats in W14 address the science question.

C. Repair it: hide every fault so the method can be called ready.

Pilot fault-and-revision desk

Route each pilot note to KEEP, REPAIR or W14 READINESS. Do not route any card to a final rock conclusion.

- Read the practice observation.
- Decide whether the method feature works or needs repair.
- Choose the precise revised instruction.
- Freeze a readiness chain and state what remains for W14.

Use the numbered cards in your pupil pack. Take turns to choose, justify and check. You may direct a partner to move a card.

Choose a group · defend your placement

- KEEP IN METHOD V2
- REPAIR THE METHOD
- W14 READINESS DECISION

State: The pilot found _____. We revised _____. The W14 route is ready / needs review because _____. The pilot cannot tell us _____.

Your independent mission

Carry out or analyse one practice pilot, record a method fault or successful check, revise the method and issue a W14 readiness decision without a final rock conclusion.

Record: Pilot checklist, one procedure observation or fault, method V1 and visibly revised V2, safety/access decision, W14 readiness card and a statement of what the pilot cannot conclude.

Choose your support and challenge

- Supported: Sequence the practice steps, choose one fault card and one matching repair, then select ready, review or fixed route for W14.
- Standard: Complete the pilot log, justify one precise revision and issue an evidence-based readiness decision.
- Stretch: Evaluate whether the revision fixes the identified fault without creating a new variable, then specify the W14 approval conditions.

Show what you know

Describe the method fault, revision and readiness decision without giving a rock conclusion.

Point to, read or explain the evidence you made. Choose one next step after the adult has listened.